



UX Case Study - Share Feature

Apratim Saxena



Overview

Founded in 2012 by Falguni Nayar, Nykaa began as an **online beauty retailer** at a time when organized beauty retail in India was largely offline and fragmented. It pivoted from a pure marketplace to a hybrid selling both owned inventory and third-party brands giving it stronger quality control and margins. Today it operates across **three verticals Nykaa Beauty, Nykaa Fashion, and Nykaa Man** serving over 42 million customers across India.

Nykaa in Numbers

42M+
customers

₹7,950 Cr
revenue
in FY25

\$8B
market cap

Core Values

**Customer-
Centricity**

Inclusivity

Innovation

Sustainability

Integrity

Some Interesting Facts

- **55.8%** female, **44.2%** male audience (surprises people since most assume it's all women)
- **25–34** largest cohort (36.53%), followed by 18–24 (36.09%)
- **2.0–2.5%** conversion rate
- **98% pin codes** served across India

Observation

What i noticed

The feature worked.
The **UI lied** about it.

- 1 A friend tapped share on a product hee liked
- 2 The share sheet showed - "**Sharing image**"
- 3 His first instinct: "*Am I just sending a random photo?*"
- 4 The app was actually sharing image + title + link.
Everything her friend needed.

Key insight

This isn't a bug. It's a **communication failure** - one label creating doubt in an otherwise perfect feature.



One Label

Two Realities

Problem

Confusion

"Sharing image" sounds like only a photo is being sent.

Hesitation

User pauses before sharing. Confidence in feature drops

Drop-off

User hesitates. Doubts the feature. Sometimes abandons.

Gap

User Thinks

I'm only sending a photo. My friend won't know what product this is.

v/s

Reality

A card is shared - image, title, and a directlink to buy the product.

What is shared



the cult-favourite
acne marks
fading serum

trusted by
10M+
BRIGHT
FACES

Check out Plum 10% Niacinamide Brightening Face Serum with Rice Water, Fades Acne Marks, for Oily to Dry Skin on Nykaa
<https://www.nykaaman.com/plum-10percent-niacinamide-face-serum-with-rice-water-for-clear-bright-skin/p/2684737?skuld=2684735&se=0>

WHY THIS EXISTS - TECHNICAL REASON

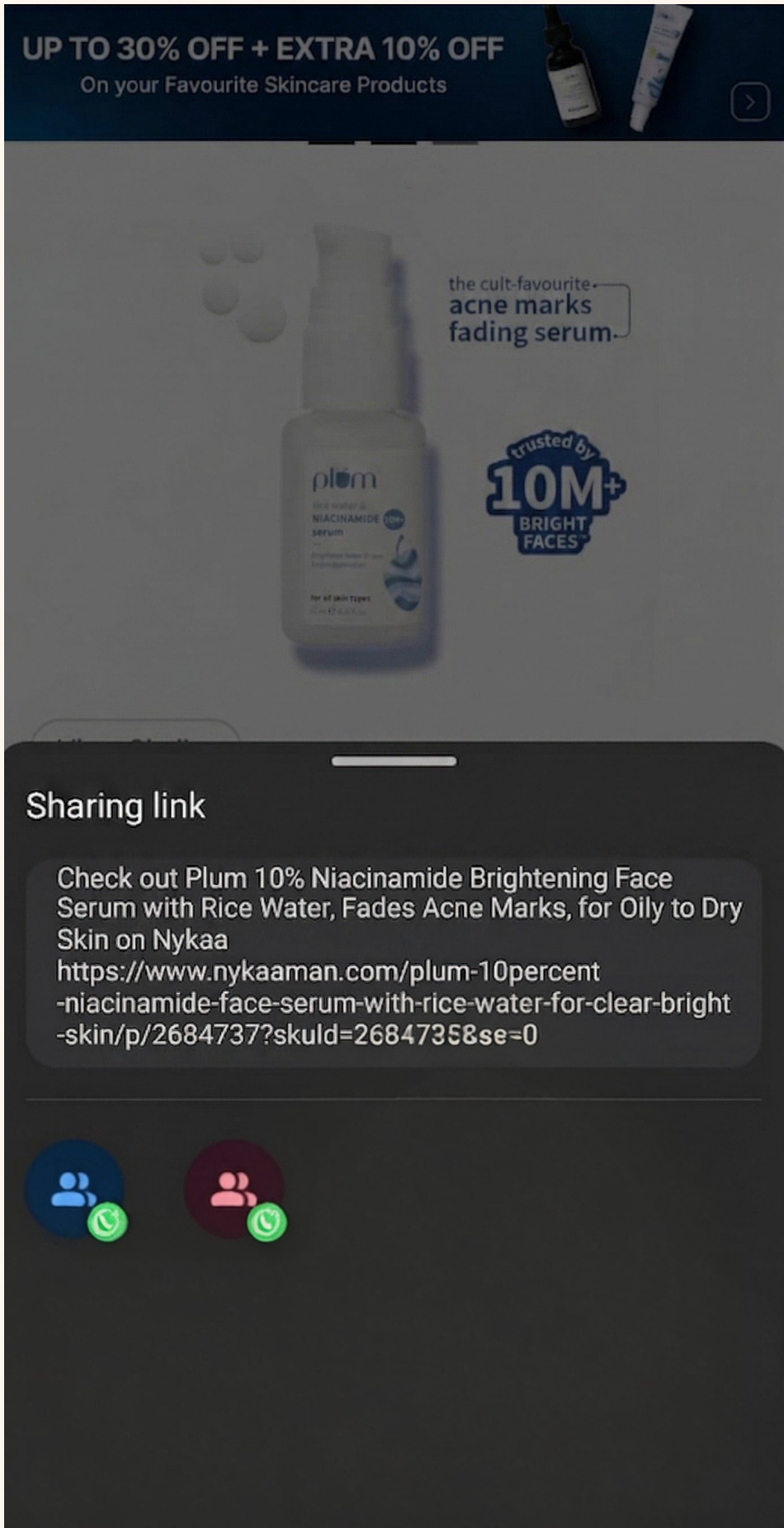
Nykaa uses the native OS share API (Android ACTION_SEND / iOS UIActivityViewController).

When a file is passed, the OS auto-labels it by its MIME type — "image/png" → "Sharing image".

Both Android and iOS allow apps to override this label.

→ Engineering default. Not a design decision.

Surface the better experience



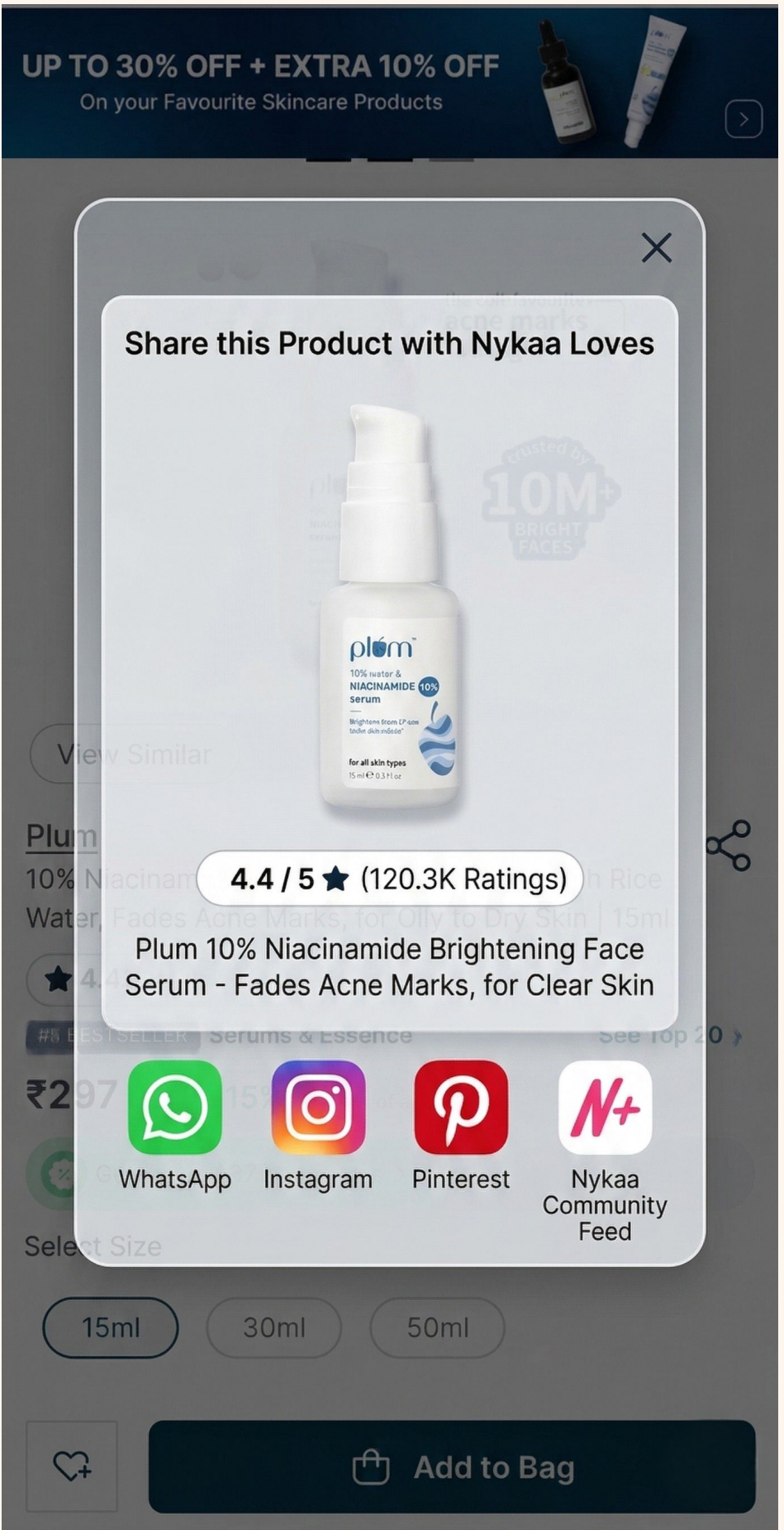
FIX A · QUICK WIN

Update the share label copy

The OS share sheet shows "Sharing link" - a system-generated label with zero context.

Immediately tells the user what they're sharing - no confusion, no hesitation.

Low effort. High clarity. Ships fast.



FIX B · BEST SOLUTION

Make the custom sheet the default

Making this the default share experience eliminates the OS label problem entirely - and turns every share into an on-brand moment.

If made the default — every share becomes an on-brand moment.

The Impact & The Metrics

1. User Impact

Clearer label = no hesitation = share completed.
User knows exactly what they're sending.

2. Business Impact

More shares = more referral visits = more purchases.
Sharing is a free acquisition channel - friction here directly hurts growth.

3. The Cost of Inaction

The fix costs nothing. The problem costs conversions.

Metric	What it measures	Direction
Share completion rate	Did the user finish sharing or abandon at the sheet?	↑
Organic referral traffic	How many users landed on Nykaa via a shared link?	↑
Share sheet drop-off rate	How many users opened share sheet but didn't share?	↓

North Star Metric - Share Completion Rate

Every use case: recommendation, opinion, or discovery fails the moment a user abandons the share sheet.